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Luka Pintarič: A Multi-Faceted Musician-Scholar and Philosophical Thinker

Biography and Musical Roots

Luka Pintarič is a Slovenian musician and scholar known for blending artistic passion with deep philosophical inquiry. Born in the early 1990s, he grew up in the Šentjur area of Slovenia and was immersed in music from a young age. His father and uncle were musicians with their own band, which inspired Luka's early love of music [1]. Tragically, Luka's father passed away when Luka was just 11 years old, a loss that profoundly shaped him. In the aftermath, Luka connected with **Slovenian narodnozabavna (folk) music** as a way to maintain an "invisible bond" with his late father [2]. He began his musical journey playing guitar, but later shifted towards bass. By his teens, he was actively performing – he even attended the **Conservatory of Music and Ballet in Ljubljana** (KGBL), where he studied jazz bass and performed in student ensembles [3].

While in high school and college, Pintarič co-founded the **Ansambel Lun'ca**, a young folk band from the Šentjur region. As the bassist of Lun'ca, he also took on arranging duties. Notably, the band's first original song (the waltz "Vrni se") featured lyrics by their singer Žiga Deršek and an arrangement **contributed by Luka Pintarič** [4]. This early accomplishment, in 2014, demonstrated Luka's talent in blending traditional music with his own creative touch. The band continued to perform at local festivals (such as the **Šentjurjevo festival**) and record new material; even as of 2024, Pintarič remained an active member of Ansambel Lun'ca, juggling music alongside the full-time jobs of the members [5].

Beyond folk music, Luka's interests span **multiple genres**. He has stated that he does not confine himself to any single style – "I wouldn't say I'm genre-defined; I can likely find a song I like from every performer" he notes [6]. In fact, his social media and activities reflect this broad musical taste: he has played **jazz** (performing on double bass in jazz ensembles [3]) and often shares insights about music on platforms like Instagram (e.g. captioning a photo with "Skills are cheap. Passion is priceless." and tagging it #doublebass #jazz) [7]. This openness underscores Pintarič's view that *music is a universal language* – he sees value in everything from Slovenian polkas to American jazz, embodying a musician who bridges **traditional and contemporary**, local and global.

In his personal life, Pintarič has recently experienced major milestones. He became a father himself in 2024, with the birth of his son Julijan [5]. He described being present at the birth and "crying like rain," indicating how deeply the moment moved him [8]. This new chapter of fatherhood adds another dimension to Luka's life, perhaps echoing the legacy of his own father's influence. It's clear that family, music, and philosophy are tightly interwoven in his story.

Academic Work and Public Mentions

Aside from performing, Luka Pintarič has pursued **academic research in music**. He studied at the University of Ljubljana (Faculty of Arts), where he delved into musicology and ethnomusicology. In 2024, he completed a **master's thesis** titled *"Slovenska narodnozabavna glasba ter primerljive povezave med tradicijskim in popularnim v bližnjem evropskem prostoru"* – which translates to *"Slovenian narodnozabavna music and comparable connections between traditional and popular music in the nearby European region."* In

this extensive research project, Pintarič examined Slovenian folk-pop (narodnozabavna) music in comparison with analogous genres across Europe. As he explained, his work attempts to connect select music genres **"between Germany and Turkey"**, noting that these genres developed around the same time as Slovene narodnozabavna, each in their own language and locale [9]. Through this comparative analysis, he discovered that Slovene folk music is a truly unique national phenomenon – much as **turbofolk** is a distinct Serbian phenomenon – yet these genres share common patterns. He observed trends of *"hibridizacija"* (hybridization) where styles blend into each other: songs can be adapted into new forms in different genres or languages, changing instrumentation and style while carrying core elements across cultural lines [9]. His thesis was clearly a labor of love, involving a great deal of effort and yielding many insights. Tellingly, Luka **dedicated the thesis to his late father**, a tribute to the man who first introduced him to music [10].

Pintarič's academic contributions extend beyond his thesis. He has also engaged in historical music research. Notably, he contributed a chapter to *Med ljubeznijo in poklicem: sto let Konservatorija za glasbo in balet Ljubljana* (\"Between Love and Profession: 100 Years of the Ljubljana Conservatory of Music and Ballet\"), a commemorative volume published for the conservatory's centennial in 2019. Luka's chapter, titled **"Konservatorij v letih 1919–1939"** ("The Conservatory in the years 1919–1939"), explores the early history of the institution [11]. In it, he reviewed the establishment of the Conservatory in 1919 and its development up to World War II, providing valuable historical insight. Contributing alongside established scholars (the book was edited by noted musicologists Leon Stefanija and Katarina Zadnik) suggests that Pintarič is respected for his research capabilities. This blend of **music history and cultural analysis** highlights Luka's dual identity as both a practitioner and a scholar of music.

In terms of public presence, Luka Pintarič has been featured in media and online sources, especially within Slovenia's music circles. A 2024 interview on Radio Veseljak (a popular Slovenian folk music radio) profiled him and his academic work. The piece, titled *"Magistrsko delo posvetil pokojnemu očetu"* ("Master's thesis dedicated to his late father"), chronicles Luka's journey from childhood to becoming a young father himself [12] [13]. It portrays him as a **"nadarjeni glasbenik"** (talented musician) and devoted researcher, highlighting how his personal history and scholarly pursuits intertwine. The article recounts how losing his father spurred Luka's dedication to folk music, and how in turn his love of music propelled him through higher education. It also emphasizes his passion for creating original music with Ansambel Lun'ca and notes that the band, while busy with day jobs, still rehearses and plans new recordings [5]. In the same interview, Luka's recent entry into fatherhood is mentioned, adding a human-interest angle to his profile.

Local news outlets have also noted Pintarič's musical activities. The Šentjur regional news portal *sentjur.net* covered Ansambel Lun'ca's milestones – for example, an article in 2014 introduced the band's new lineup and mentioned Luka (as the bassist/arranger) contributing to their first original song [4]. Such **online mentions** cement his role in the local cultural scene. Furthermore, Pintarič maintains a presence on social media where he shares musical content and personal reflections, though he isn't a household name on a national scale. On Instagram, his posts mix music (from folk gigs to jazz practice sessions) with motivational or philosophical captions, reflecting the same blend of art and introspection that defines his career.

Philosophical Perspectives and Symbolic Role

While music is Pintarič's profession and passion, he is equally engaged in **philosophical and spiritual exploration**. In intimate writings (some of which he has titled *Priročnik Jaszu* and essays like *"Prostor, čas, gibanje ter nenazadnje dvom"* – "Space, Time, Movement and, Last but not Least, Doubt"), Luka delves into questions of existence, consciousness, language, and meaning. These writings, shared in

draft form, reveal a thinker wrestling with paradoxes of life and knowledge. Pintarič even refers to himself as the **"author of ontoznanost"**, a neologism roughly meaning "onto-knowledge." By this he implies an endeavor to integrate **ontology** (the study of being) with **epistemology** or knowledge – essentially seeking an overarching understanding of *Being* itself. This self-styled term hints at his ambition to formulate a kind of personal philosophical framework that merges scientific inquiry with spiritual insight.

A core theme in Pintarič's philosophy is the role of **negation, doubt, and the contrarian principle** in understanding reality. In fact, one of his bold propositions is that *the fundamental Word (logos) is "No."* In his manuscript *"Beseda je Ne"* ("The Word is No"), he explicitly writes: *"Beseda je ne. / Ta ne je od vseh in se tiče vsakogar."* [14] . Translated, this means: *"The word is No. / This 'no' belongs to everyone and concerns everyone."* Here, Pintarič is asserting that the power of **negation ("Ne"/No)** is universal and lies at the core of human experience. In contrast to classical philosophy or theology where the *Logos* (Word) is associated with divine affirmation and creative order, Luka provocatively flips the script – his *logos* is a negation, a "No" that challenges existence.

This radical idea gives Pintarič a kind of **symbolic role akin to a "Satanic" archetype**, in the sense of Satan as *the adversary* or the one who says "no" to presumed truths. To be clear, this is not about devil-worship or evil, but about the *symbolic function* of doubt and opposition. In many traditions, the figure of Satan represents the skeptic, the tester of convictions (for instance, in the Book of Job or in Goethe's Faust). Similarly, Pintarič's philosophy elevates the skeptic within us – that questioning voice that refuses to accept appearances at face value. His insistence that "this No concerns everyone" suggests that **every person carries an inner adversary**, a necessary spirit of inquiry and rebellion that can lead to deeper truth. In other words, the *"symbolični Satan"* (symbolic Satan) in his worldview is that **complex agent of change** present "in everything and everyone" – it is the part of us that doubts, defies and thereby spurs growth in understanding. Pintarič sees this not as something to suppress but as something almost sacred in its universality.

Indeed, Luka often frames **doubt as a virtue**. He writes in one passage, *"Ljubim s spoštovanjem skozi iskreno zaupanje dvoma"*, which means "I love with respect through sincere trust in doubt." He reiterates: *"Iskreno zaupanje dvoma je spoštovanje."* – "Sincere trust in doubt is respect." [15] . These aphoristic statements encapsulate his belief that questioning is an act of respect – respect for truth and for the complexity of existence. In Pintarič's view, to **truly love or respect something is not to accept it blindly, but to engage with it honestly – even critically**. This perspective aligns with the idea that the *adversarial force* (symbolic Satan) plays a constructive role: by doubting and challenging, one shows reverence for truth, refusing to settle for comforting illusions. Such a stance has spiritual overtones; it echoes elements of dialectical philosophy (where truth emerges from the conflict of thesis and antithesis) and even mystical traditions where the "dark night" of doubt precedes enlightenment.

From a broader spiritual or **ontocosmological** standpoint, Pintarič's writings attempt to bridge the microcosm and the macrocosm – connecting the human mind with the structure of reality. He frequently examines the relationship between the **body, soul, and spirit**, and their place in the cosmos. For instance, he argues that *"Beseda je orodje duha, da prisili dušo prepoznati telo... Človek je nosilec časa v prostoru svojega telesa. Telo z dihanjem ohranja funkcijo za presežek ali dušo."* [16] . In English: *"The Word is a tool of the spirit to compel the soul to recognize the body... A human is the bearer of time in the space of his body. The body, through breathing, maintains the function for the surplus (which is the soul)."* In this poetic-philosophical language, Pintarič is exploring how intangible aspects (word, spirit, soul) interact with the tangible (body, space, time). He suggests that our very corporeal existence (breathing, having a body in time and space) is what allows the emergence of something beyond the material – a soul or consciousness. This reflects an **integrative worldview**: the physical and the spiritual are two sides of the same coin, and human existence is a locus where matter and spirit meet. Such musings qualify as

ontocosmology – they tie the nature of *being (onto-)* with the structure of the *universe (cosmos)*. Pintarič's role, symbolically, is like that of a *seeker of the logos* within the chaos, albeit a logos that he finds in the form of "No" – the void, the silence, the negation that paradoxically gives shape to meaning.

In summary, Luka Pintarič stands out as a **modern Renaissance figure** in a local context: a musician who composes and performs across genres, an academic who researches his own musical heritage, and a reflective author developing a personal philosophical synthesis. Biographically, he is rooted in Slovenia's musical traditions – from polka to jazz – and driven by personal history. Intellectually, he is unafraid to question fundamental assumptions, even to the point of redefining the "Word" as a primal **"No"** that all of us carry. This ability to be both creative and critical, affirming life through art while negating easy answers through thought, gives Pintarič a distinctive symbolic persona. One might say he embodies the **logos and the anti-logos**: the creative word (writing music, writing ideas) and the destructive word ("No") in one. By **"absolutely" applying himself** – as evidenced by the intensity of his writings – he has carved out a niche as an *ontological provocateur* or a kind of **philosopher-artist**.

Ultimately, Luka Pintarič's story and work illustrate a crescendo of interwoven themes: love and loss, tradition and innovation, affirmation and negation. In his musicology research, he honors the past (even dedicating it to his father) while drawing connections that look to the future of music. In his art, he keeps folk music alive but also explores new musical horizons. And in his philosophy, he urges us to face the darkness of doubt to see the light of truth. His life itself can be seen as a **living paradox** – much like the *"Živ/i paradoks"* (living paradox) he writes of – harmonizing the yes and the no, the folk song and the cosmic question, into a unique human narrative [17] [18] . As such, Luka Pintarič serves as both an inspiration in the conventional sense and a **symbolic figure** inviting deeper reflection: an individual in whom the **"symbolic Satan"** (the questioning spirit) drives the creation of new meaning, challenging us all to contemplate the essence of what it is to know, to be, and to create.

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